

Apply to be a Science Corps Fellow - Entry #3370

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Gender
Female
Residence: City (State), Country
Cambridge (Massachusetts), USA
Nationality
Australian
When did you or do you expect to complete your PhD?
2023
Please tell us briefly about your university education (institution, city, country, year)
University of Technology Sydney, B.Sc. Marine Biology, Australia, 2016 University of Technology Sydney, B.Sc. (Honours) in Environmental Science, Australia, 2017 University of Cambridge, Ph.D. Plant Science, United Kingdom, 2023
Why would you like to be a Science Corps Fellow?
I am extremely passionate about making science more accessible and understandable to the wider community. Academic scientists do such wonderful work, though there is a mismatch between our findings and being able to communicate that effectively to a wider audience. Without being able to share our science through outreach and community engagement, our ability to get people to care about science will not be realised. I recognise that this is also an issue in communities that may not be as privileged in terms of science education. What I see as so valuable through the Science Corp program is its goal to provide science opportunities globally. Most importantly it is about how we can empower students to envisage a future where they can be a scientist in whatever field they are passionate about. That is the main reason why I would like to be a Science Corp Fellow, and I believe that starts with being able to share my knowledge and skillset with students so that complex scientific ideas can be translated into accessible and inspiring learning experiences that they can take with them in their futures. Equally important, I see being a Science Corp Fellow as a wonderful opportunity to work alongside educators, students and local communities to co-create sustainable scientific resources that can be used to support continued learning, which I feel is a very meaningful opportunity.

In addition to your studies, please describe any prior experience that may help you as a Science Corps Fellow.

Beyond my formal research training, I have built a strong foundation in teaching, mentoring, and educational resource development. I was most heavily involved in these aspects while I was a student at the University of Technology Sydney. As part of the Science Outreach Team, I designed and led interactive sessions for prospective students and visiting school groups. I found a lot of joy speaking to students about my love of science and hoped that it inspired students to follow their passions. I engaged in teaching through tutorials and laboratory classes. One of the ways I particularly enjoyed working with students was not for them to rote learn the material, but by guiding them to come to the answer themselves. I found it much more valuable to them to not be told the answer, but to use the knowledge they didn't realise they had and reasoning to find the answer to the question or problem. During my time at Cambridge University, I delivered small group tutorials in Plant Biochemistry that focussed on the same idea, of guiding students to a deeper understanding of the material they were learning. This work also involved tailoring the tutorials to the type of students I had as each had different learning styles and backgrounds. At MIT, I continued this work though this was more often in a more dynamic environment at sea or in the laboratory. All these experiences together taught me to hone my communication skills to varied audiences, whether it needed to be for someone with little background in the sciences or to those with advanced technical knowledge. Additionally, I bring strong leadership and collaboration experience from organising events with diverse teams, at the student, collegiate and city council level. As May Ball President, I coordinated a team of 20 students over 9 months to organise a 1000-person event in Cambridge. This experience particularly strengthened my organisational skills, my adaptability under pressure, and the success of the event showed my ability to thrive in a dynamic environment working with many different personalities. This I believe will add to my preparedness to be a Science Corp Fellow.

Where do you imagine yourself professionally in the future? Check all that apply.

Scientist in academia
In science education
In science outreach

Please expand on your selection above and describe where you imagine yourself professionally in the near (~2 year) and long-term (~10 year) future.

In the next two years, I imagine myself to continue growing as a scientist and educator, building upon the opportunity as a Science Corp Fellow to further integrate my teaching, mentorship and community engagement into my career. I would particularly like to bring this experience back into academia where I feel that good science communication and teaching is still lacking.

In the long term, I aspire to lead a research group in marine oceanography. Sharing my passion for the ocean, its importance and value is a key driver of my work. A key aspect of this is to prioritise research training but also soft skills such as communication and story telling through outreach. I envisage partnering with schools, community organisations and international collaborators to make the science community a more inclusive space. Importantly I would like for students discovering science to see people that look like them in successful positions doing good science, so that they can feel empowered and aspire to that if they wish. I don't think is good enough for academics to publish in journals because the knowledge and research only reaches a select set of people and it is important

for us to share what we find with the community which would be the basis of where my research directions and goals would lead me.

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An email list in your institution

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